

taking some amount of cognitive load off from the driver by making the car being driven autonomous in many ways. Basically, Audi Connect is an in-car infotainment system which can turn the car into a mobile WiFi hotspot by directly being connected to an ISP of choice. Currently, Audi is trying to improve the Human-machine interface in the car by making use of gesture controlled systems instead of the usual knobs and buttons.

Self driving cars: Dream or reality? Tesla to BMW:

Self-driving cars have long been portrayed as the future of road travel in plenty of movies like iRobot, Demolition Man and Total Recall to name a few. These just showed a glimpse of what is capable with autonomous vehicles and paved the way for various biggies in the technology world to actually come up with their own self-driving car concepts. Surprisingly enough, it was in the late 1970s that the Tsukuba Mechanical Engineering Lab of Japan tested out a computerized driverless car that could achieve 32 Km/h and follow the road by tracking white coloured road markers. But it was in the early 1980s when Ernst Dickmanns, a german pioneer made a VaMoRs Mercedes van drive hundreds of miles autonomously on the highway as a part of the Eureka PROMETHEUS project. This was a huge feat considering the extremely limited amount of computing power available during that period. Time moved on and there were plenty of notable improvements in driverless car technology as a lot of organisations tried to fund amateur to professional autonomous car projects. It was in 2004 that even the U.S. Defense Advanced Research Projects Administration (DARPA) had its hand in the push for success as they challenged multiple teams and made them compete for a huge prize of \$1million to come up with a good working concept. They tested the prospects in the desert and named the event “The DARPA Grand Challenge” back then. Over the years, this project led to some serious developments in technology and the difference could be seen with the availability of better software for road-following, improved sensor and radar use and most of all, better collision avoidance. Researchers also found that an improvement in roadmapping helped them develop software that lets the car know everything of importance around it thus making it somewhat self-aware when it drives and lets it act according to certain unknown variations.

As of today, there are plenty of players in the industry when it comes to building and deploying autonomous cars and interestingly enough a few of their creations are even commercially available for purchase. The